

FIT for FAIR – Cross-Country Insights on Operationalising EU Due Diligence Legislations

Cross-Country Learnings Webinar - Event Report

Webinars - 29 June 2026,

Morning session: 09:00–12:00 Geneva (CET) - Afternoon session: 16:00–17:30 Geneva (CET)

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Note on the findings presented:

The findings presented in this report reflect a synthesis of diverse views and experiences gathered through webinars, discussions and documents produced in the context of the FIT for FAIR project. We have done our best to summarise the main cross-country findings; however, these may not apply equally to every context or country, and should be read as illustrative rather than exhaustive.

Executive Summary

On 29 June 2026, the International Trade Centre (ITC), with the support of GIZ and funded by BMZ, convened the FIT for FAIR Cross-Country Learnings Webinar - a milestone event marking the closing of the current phase of the FIT for FAIR project. The webinar was held in two sessions (morning and afternoon Geneva time) to accommodate participants across Africa, Latin America and Southeast Asia, drawing a combined audience of over 70 registered participants from six partner countries and beyond.

FIT for FAIR has been active across six countries - Colombia, Cambodia, Thailand, Ethiopia, Rwanda and Côte d'Ivoire - supporting the creation of the legal and institutional conditions needed to prepare supply chain actors for the EU Deforestation Regulation (EUDR) and the Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD). In each country, multi-stakeholder working groups were established, national frameworks were analysed against EU requirements, and policy recommendations with implementation roadmaps were developed and handed over to national authorities and partner organisations.

The webinar brought together all six partner countries to share what was achieved, compare experiences and identify transferable lessons. Country presentations were complemented by cross-regional exchange highlights from Latin America (December 2025) and Asia–Ethiopia (May 2026), and closed with an open stakeholder reflection session. A second phase of FIT for FAIR is already planned, and the event served to cement the network of practitioners built over the project's lifetime.

1. FIT for FAIR Programme Overview

The session opened with an overview of the FIT for FAIR project, active across six countries over approximately two and a half years. Three main activity clusters were outlined:

- Awareness raising and capacity building: multi-stakeholder working groups established in each country, bringing together government, civil society, certification bodies and producer organisations to build shared understanding of the EUDR and CSDDD.
- National framework analysis and policy recommendations: working groups analysed national legal frameworks against EU requirements and jointly developed policy recommendations with accompanying implementation roadmaps.
- Cross-country knowledge exchange: ITC facilitated peer learning between countries and regions, the outputs of which are the focus of this report.

Selected programme highlights were shared, including: a field exchange between European operators and Colombian producers; a coffee sector study exchange between Ethiopia and Vietnam; the formation of a National Due Diligence task force in Côte d'Ivoire, a Uganda coffee platform visit to Rwanda; the Thailand policy recommendation handover to the Ministry of Agriculture; and the high-level stakeholder workshop in Cambodia.

2. Country Findings

Rwanda

The Rwanda FIT for FAIR process ran from January 2025 to February 2026, establishing a 28-member working group drawn from public institutions, private sector actors and development partners. The project focused on coffee - Rwanda's second-largest export commodity - which generates USD 78.7 million annually, directs over 60% of production to the EU market, and involves over 400,000 smallholder farmers.

Discussions were structured around four thematic areas:

- **Legality:** Rwanda has a strong foundation of laws covering environmental protection, labour rights and human rights. The national land tenure regularisation programme was identified as a key enabler for readiness for EUDR and CSDDD. Continued awareness raising and capacity building for exporters and producers remains a priority.
- **Traceability:** Rwanda has made meaningful progress on farm-level mapping and digital traceability, particularly among certified cooperatives and exporters who have invested in their own internal control systems. At the national level, three distinct government-managed digital systems are relevant to coffee traceability: the National Land Tenure Registration system, the Forestry system, and the Coffee Plantation system maintained by the National Agriculture and Export Development Board (NAEB). These systems hold foundational data on land ownership, land use and registered coffee farmers - effectively constituting a national farmer census - but they currently operate in silos and do not communicate with one another. This fragmentation, combined with the absence of national standards for geolocation data, limited digital infrastructure in rural areas, and poor interoperability between public and private platforms, remains the central traceability challenge. The path forward involves integrating these three systems into a unified national traceability architecture, scaling cooperative-level internal control systems, harmonising geolocation and data standards, and investing in accessible innovations such as QR-coded farmer identification cards and mobile applications that can function in low-connectivity environments.
- **Smallholder integration:** Over 90% of Rwandan coffee is produced by smallholders, who are indirectly affected by EU regulations. National support programmes are being designed to facilitate their participation, and cooperative-led traceability structures are considered essential.
- **Decent work, living wages and circular economy:** Labour laws are robust but implementation gaps persist. No clear living wage benchmark exists in the coffee sector. Opportunities include collaboration with certification schemes to link premium pricing to improved livelihoods, and strengthening waste management practices.

Côte d'Ivoire

The Côte d'Ivoire process engaged approximately 90 stakeholders over one and a half years through working groups covering environmental due diligence, legality, traceability and human rights. A national roadmap with concrete policy recommendations was developed and handed over by the national lead implementing partner Conseil National des Exportations (CNE) to relevant ministries such as the Ministry for Agriculture, Ministry for Trade and Ministry of Justice in July 2025. CNE has

since established a National Due Diligence Task Force to follow up on implementation. Key policy recommendations included:

- Traceability and data governance: Development of a national governance framework for data collection and protection, and improved interoperability across commodity-specific traceability systems, including social dimensions of traceability.
- Strengthening women's rights: Enhanced access to agricultural land and greater participation in decision-making processes, with specific activities embedded in the roadmap.
- Awareness raising and training: Campaigns for stakeholders along the value chain on the regulations' requirements and opportunities, including simplified explanations of national legislation such as the Code Forestier.
- Human rights framework: Strengthening access to judicial services and grievance mechanisms, and centralising human rights data within traceability systems.

Cambodia

Cambodia's FIT for FAIR engagement launched with a full-day workshop on 18 February 2026 in Phnom Penh, jointly organised with EuroCham Cambodia and ITC. Around 80 participants joined from government, the private sector, producer organisations and development partners. The workshop covered five forest-risk commodities: palm oil, rubber, timber, coffee and cashew. Three themes emerged from discussions:

- EUDR readiness and compliance: EUDR preparedness was framed from the outset as a matter of national competitiveness rather than purely regulatory compliance. Legality documentation, geolocation data and risk assessment were identified as practical building blocks. The CSDDD was discussed alongside EUDR to highlight the broader human rights due diligence dimension. Private sector participants shared concrete deforestation-free production practices in cashew and rubber.
- Traceability and smallholder inclusion: The biggest challenges identified were costs, data availability and appropriate governance structures - not purely technical issues. Consensus emerged that digital systems will only succeed if accessible and affordable for smaller producers together with proper governance structure. Cambodia is developing a national agricultural traceability app under the Department of Digital Transformation, supported by FAO, currently in pilot phase covering all agricultural commodities.
- Partnerships and next steps: The EU Delegation emphasised EUDR as an incentive for higher standards and stronger competitiveness. Coordinated action between government, private sector and development partners was highlighted as essential. EuroCham is establishing working groups for further gap analysis and policy recommendations.

It was also noted that some agricultural stakeholders expressed scepticism about compliance costs and the long-term value of traceability investments. While under EUDR regulatory compliance obligations rest with operators and traders placing relevant commodities on the EU market, participants highlighted concerns about how implementation costs may be distributed along the supply chain, particularly for smallholder producers—an issue common across all partner countries.

Latin America Regional Exchange - Colombia

A Regional Technical Exchange on Zero Deforestation and Human Rights was held on 15 December 2025, bringing together Colombia, Costa Rica, Ecuador and El Salvador, implemented in partnership with Confecámaras. Discussions were organised around three themes:

- Human rights and informality: Informality in rural value chains was identified as a structural challenge driven by low income, family-based farming, seasonal labour and a mismatch between rural realities and urban-designed regulatory frameworks. Treating informality as a structural issue - rather than deliberate non-compliance - was seen as essential for designing effective due diligence. Differentiated, territorially grounded approaches were highlighted as a key best practice from Colombia.
- Traceability and data governance: Fragmented systems, high implementation costs and unclear rules on data ownership were identified as the main bottlenecks. Public-sector-led, interoperable traceability systems with clear data protection and validation rules - and tangible benefits for producers - were proposed as the path forward. A pilot dialogue between operators, exporters and producers was highlighted as a transferable best practice.
- Financing and inclusion: Compliance costs frequently outweigh perceived benefits for small producers. Long-term blended finance, stronger institutional capacity and closer alignment between buyer requirements and investment strategies are needed. Special attention to women and young producers was flagged as a priority.

Cross-Regional Exchange: Asia & Ethiopia

A cross-regional webinar held on 11 May 2026 brought together 61 participants from Thailand, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Malaysia, Vietnam and Europe, hosted in partnership with the Thai Environmental Institute (TEI) and Thailand National Bureau of Agricultural Commodity and Food Standards (ACFS). Three main themes emerged:

- Thailand's national traceability platform: Thailand is developing a National EUDR Single Window - a cloud-based system linked to the Department of Agriculture that generates GeoJSON files and simplified due-diligence reports for EU operators. The platform is coordinated across more than 30 agencies through a National Committee on EUDR and is free for Thai citizens and businesses to use.
- Ethiopia's traceability experience: The Ethiopian Coffee Traceability Management System (ECTMS) was shared as a case study, emphasising that traceability is not only about tracking a product but about building trust in the data behind it. The system uses QR-coded producer IDs to include smallholders without smartphones and integrates with customs for export verification.
- Smallholder inclusion: Both countries converged on this as the core shared challenge. Thailand cited a rubber traceability pilot aligned with GAP/FSC/PEFC/EUDR standards, planned for July 2026 and free for farmers, as well as a cooperative-based model for channelling smallholder sales with full traceability. Indonesia's SVLK system was presented as a strong regional reference for mandatory, third-party verified, export-ready traceability.

3. Lessons Learnt - Shared Areas for Action

Six themes emerged consistently across all six partner countries:

1) **Smallholder inclusion and informality:**

Smallholders are central to every supply chain examined. Approaches must reflect rural realities and diverse livelihood strategies. Informality should be understood as a structural challenge, not deliberate non-compliance, and due diligence systems should enable progressive improvement rather than immediate exclusion.

2) **Traceability and data governance:**

Accessible, interoperable and cost-efficient systems are needed. Data ownership, governance and privacy rules are as important as the digital tools themselves. Without trust in how data is managed, traceability systems cannot function effectively. Public-private collaboration emerged as an essential enabler.

3) **Financing gaps:**

Compliance costs frequently outweigh perceived benefits for smaller actors. Long-term, blended financing and sustained institutional capacity are needed. Solutions that generate tangible benefits for producers - improved market access, reduced compliance burden - are critical to sustaining engagement.

4) **Governance and institutional mandates:**

Progress was strongest where legal frameworks, institutional responsibilities and political ownership were already in place. Technology alone cannot compensate for fragmented governance. Cross-ministerial coordination and binding regulation are essential.

5) **Legality and land tenure:**

Geolocation is technically feasible; proving legal land use is harder. Informal occupation, customary tenure and diverse ownership arrangements complicate legality documentation across all regions. As legality requirements depend on the applicable national legal framework, land titles are not necessarily required where other forms of legally recognised tenure exist. Multi-stakeholder processes to jointly define the applicable legal framework have proven the most workable approach.

6) **Technology complexity and digital inclusion:**

Technologies required for due diligence are often complex and costly. User-friendly, affordable and context-appropriate digital solutions are needed, particularly offline-compatible tools and approaches that engage youth in rural areas.

Across both sessions, a recurring observation was that the most valuable cross-country insight is not that countries share the same challenges, but that they have developed different responses to them - some government-led, some cooperative-based; some starting with legal reform, others with pilot technology. This diversity of approaches is precisely what makes cross-country exchange so valuable.

4. Stakeholder Discussion - Key Points Raised

Both sessions closed with an open discussion guided by three questions: what participants found most valuable in the FIT for FAIR process; updates on EUDR preparation progress; and what resonated from the cross-country presentations. Key points raised:

Room 1 - Readiness and challenges

- Thailand: Confirmed that the national traceability platform is now live and free to use, with API links to key agricultural agencies. The platform's reporting and data export functions still require refinement to better support operators' due-diligence processes before full operationalisation.
- Cambodia - national traceability update: Cambodia's national agricultural traceability app, developed under the Department of Digital Transformation with FAO support, is in pilot phase. Observations from a recent EUDR regional workshop in Hanoi noted that commodity-specific stand-alone systems risk being costly to maintain, reinforcing Cambodia's decision to develop a single cross-commodity platform.
- Cambodia - indigenous land inclusion: The need was raised for government-issued digital maps of Community Protected Areas (CPAs) that traceability software can integrate, so these areas are correctly recognised as legally protected zones that may also host agricultural production.
- Resources for SMEs: ITC's EUDR handbook was highlighted as a freely available resource on compliance requirements for producers and exporters, alongside national country-specific materials.

Room 2 - Data collection and traceability

- Thailand - three takeaways: (1) Communication is essential to drive policy implementation - FIT for FAIR training created common understanding where confusion had previously existed; (2) cross-country knowledge sharing and collaboration should continue; (3) external drivers such as EUDR and CSDDD have been unusually effective at mobilising unprecedented government coordination in Thailand, with 15 policy recommendations produced and the national traceability platform launched.
- Côte d'Ivoire - project experience: The inclusive multi-stakeholder approach - bringing together ministries, producers, cooperatives, certification bodies and civil society - was highlighted as the most valuable aspect of the process. CNE's role as a consultative institution is continuing beyond the project, with next steps including a communication strategy to share progress at the sectoral level, roadmap implementation and a focus on attracting sustainable investment for smallholder inclusion.

- Côte d'Ivoire - traceability progress: The national cocoa traceability system, with producer ID cards issued to all cocoa farmers, will be operational for the 2026–27 campaign. Progress is also being made on rubber traceability.
- Côte d'Ivoire - data standardisation: Data standardisation and interoperability were identified as the real bottlenecks. Practical, low-cost tools for smallholders are being developed with the private sector. A benchmark or typology of traceability tools by farm size and context was suggested as a useful output for all countries.
- Legality clarification: A question was raised on confusion about which legislation applies to different plot and land-use situations under EUDR. The response emphasised that this is one of the most complex issues across all countries, and that a multi-stakeholder process to jointly define the applicable legal framework - rather than seeking a one-size-fits-all answer - has been the most effective approach.

5. Further readings

Zero Deforestation Hub: <https://zerodeforestationhub.eu/>

Rwanda

- Aligning Rwanda's Coffee Sector with the EUDR and CSDDD: A Strategic Roadmap and Gaps and Opportunities Assessment

Côte d'Ivoire

- FIT for FAIR Project Study Report - Ivory Coast

Cross-Country

- FIT for FAIR - Cross-Country Insights on Operationalising EU Due Diligence Regulations

Colombia

- Technical Report: Results of the FIT for FAIR Colombia Project - Closing Gaps to Facilitate Exports of Agricultural Products to Germany and the European Union
- Colombian Model for Due Diligence in the Agricultural Sector
- Roadmap for Due Diligence on Zero Deforestation, Traceability and Human Rights